research as I went along, finding out who the people in the video were, when it was shot, from which angles, and how it had all come together to tell the story of this multiple murder in broad daylight. We broke the film into three parts, to better understand the sequence of events. The work was slow, but sobering and mesmerising. When all was said and done, the video, without doubt, showed twelve men – two of them Reuters journalists, going about their business – being shot to ribbons by 35mm cannon-fire from a US Apache helicopter. It took me some time to work out who was involved in the initial massacre, and then to see that the two men who survived the initial attack, only to be taken out individually, were the men from Reuters. It was my colleague Ingi Ragnar Ingason who noticed, on closer inspection, that the van that comes to pick up one of the wounded men and is blown apart in a further round of cannon-fire, contained two children. The footage later shows US ground troops carrying the wounded children away.

We had a full team working on it. Kristinn Hrafnsson took charge of research, finding out what had happened to the children in the video. Birgitta was there throughout, giving advice and acting as a sounding-board for what appeared. Ingi was editor, which involved shedding away a lot of the flak and immaterial stuff on the rough cut, and Gudmundur Gudmudsson worked with the sound. We had Rop Gonggrijp as executive producer, covering expenses and making it possible, and Smári McCarthy organising the web-based material. Daniel Domscheit-Berg, unknown even to himself, perhaps, had begun to marginalise himself from this working group by undermining our efforts. It's inevitable, I suppose, in a group of people who are essentially volunteers, that questions of ambition and motivation will go askew. Domscheit-Berg couldn't see the wood for the trees and became tremendously obnoxious. We were involved in something very large and very scary, and his ill-will was exhausting.

One of the things that drove us was the knowledge of how inaccurate the contemporary press reports of the incident had been. It was an example of history being manipulated for political purposes. It was even suggested in some reports that the van had been shelled by insurgents, but the video shows very clearly the order being given and the massacre occurring. Others suggested that there was a fire-fight and that the Reuters journalists had been caught in the crossfire. All lies. We appended a quote from George Orwell – 'Political language is designed to make lies sound truthful and murder respectable, and to give the appearance of solidity to pure wind' –